SUBJECT: Scientific Computing Support

RELATED DOCUMENTS

ACA 8700 Academic Software Management.

SECTION 1 POLICY STATEMENT

1.1. Khalifa University of Science and Technology provides appropriate scientific computing support to ensure that resources and services are used effectively. It clearly defines the limits of this support in order that it not duplicate or replace researcher effort.

SECTION 2 SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

2.1. This policy document applies to all faculty, staff, and students and any approved affiliates of Khalifa University of Science and Technology, all referred to here as "Users".

SECTION 3 PURPOSE

3.1. Enabling and supporting world class research at Khalifa University of Science and Technology (KU) requires leading edge research computing services, expertise, consultancy and training.

3.2. The primary goal of this policy is to define the role of the Scientific Computing Support function, and how it engages with researchers, in order to effectively utilize research computing resources and facilities and advance research at KU.

SECTION 4 DEFINITIONS

The following definition(s) apply to this policy document:

4.1. **Research Computing (RC) Resources:** All centrally provided research computing facilities such as hardware, software, HPC cluster, etc. that are managed by the Research Computing department.

4.2. **High Performance Computer (HPC) Cluster:** A computing system platform incorporating software architecture implemented from off-the-shelf computing hardware to provide high-performance and data-intensive processing.

4.3. **Faculty Sponsor:** A member of faculty, typically a Principle Investigator (PI), research group leader, or research student supervisor, who requests an account on RC systems for students, members of their research group or research engineers.

SECTION 5 PROVISIONS AND GUIDELINES

5.1. *Scientific Computing Support*

5.1.1. Scientific Computing Support is provided to users to aid in the effective provision and utilization of RC resources. The support provided will range from training, assisting researchers in running their codes on RC resources to

The online version of this policy document is definitive.

providing consultation on performance analysis and code optimization. This support is not intended as a replacement to research staff effort, but rather to provide expertise to support research efforts; the researchers are the subject matter experts and the Scientific Computing support team are experts in computational techniques and the use of RC resources.

5.2. It is anticipated that there will be short, medium and long-term engagements between users and Scientific Computing support.

5.2.1. *Short-term Engagement*: This typically takes the form of short group or one-on-one training sessions to get started with using RC resources, or to discuss a specific issue. All users are eligible for this type of engagement.

5.2.2. *Medium-term Engagement*: This typically is required for issues that require more in-depth analysis of performance and/scalability, or algorithm selection. All users are eligible for this type of support. The support team may on occasion contact a user's faculty sponsor to ensure that the amount of support being provided is deemed appropriate, for instance not interfering with a student's learning.

5.2.3. *Long-term Engagement*: This typically consist of longer term projects, such assistance in parallelizing, or porting code from one computer language to another. The scope of the engagement, the time required, responsibilities during and after the engagement are clearly defined at the outset. All requests are considered by the RC department and assessed by evaluating the requirements, the availability of resources and the impact on other users. This type of engagement can only be requested by members of faculty.

SECTION 6 RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1. The department of Research Computing is responsible for enforcing this policy document and its provisions in order to ensure the effective use of resources.

6.2. All users of RC resources are responsible for complying with the conditions of use of RC resources, as well as the applicable ICT acceptable use policies and guidelines.

SECTION 7 REVIEW STATEMENT

7.1. This policy document is reviewed once every four (4) years, or more frequently when requested by the Senior Vice President for Research and Development.

SECTION 8 APPROVAL AUTHORITY AND REVISION HISTORY

This policy document has been approved by the Khalifa University of Science and Technology's Board of Trustees. Original documentation is on file in the Office of the President. The online version is definitive.

First disseminated by the Office of the SVP for Research and Development on 01 January 2018
Most Recent Review: 01 January 2018
Revision History:

Revision No.	Effective Date	Description
2		
1		
0	01 January 2018	Policy document first approved

Next scheduled review: 01 January 2022

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